MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer -> DevOps

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

DevOps / platform engineering-focused engineer with 7 years of experience in QA automation, including the last two focused primarily on CI/CD, test infrastructure and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines and Helm-based ephemeral environments for three product teams, working with namespace-level access on a shared Kubernetes cluster operated by the platform team. Personal infrastructure projects include a k3s homelab managed with Argo CD and Terraform-provisioned Hetzner VPS infrastructure. Owns CI/CD and test-infrastructure improvements across three product teams, documents technical processes used for onboarding, and mentors junior colleagues. Delivered measurable improvements in pipeline performance, environment provisioning, and test observability. Transitioning toward a full-time DevOps / platform engineering role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure & CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Terraform (personal project), Argo CD
Infrastructure as Code: Terraform (personal Hetzner VPS project), Ansible (basic)
Containers & Linux: Kubernetes (namespace-level access; Helm deployments to a shared cluster), k3s, Linux
Monitoring: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki; dashboards for test metrics
Programming & scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, GitLab API
Databases & testing: PostgreSQL, pytest, pytest-xdist, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Cloud learning: AWS EC2 and S3 basics (personal learning); Hetzner VPS

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw *2021–Present*

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, as well as artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by profiling pipelines, parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request test environments with Docker Compose and later Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster. Environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data; they are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Enabled QA and product teams to review merge-request features and run end-to-end tests in isolated environments before merge.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling to seed PostgreSQL test data and built a Python/GitLab API workflow to collect test results for Grafana dashboards.
- Wrote the internal guide to how CI works, used in onboarding, and mentored two QA interns in 2023.
- Work with namespace-level access on the shared Kubernetes cluster; the platform team operates the cluster.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java/Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, reproducing bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster and deployed applications from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, plus Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.

- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health *2023–2024*

- Implemented short-lived application and PostgreSQL environments deployed via Helm to a shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI.
- Enabled QA and product teams to review features before merge and run end-to-end tests against each environment; environments are automatically destroyed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Helm, Kubernetes, Docker, Bash, PostgreSQL.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health *2022*

- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and separated end-to-end tests into a dedicated stage.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Docker, pytest-xdist.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health *2023*

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and created Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- The flaky rate fell from 7% to below 1% after teams began addressing the most frequent failures.
- Technologies: Python, PostgreSQL, Grafana, GitLab API.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation; exam booked for January 2027 (not yet passed)

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)